

ch12 Gravitation

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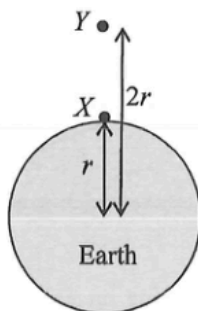
2026 Q12

2015 Q11

11. The gravitational force exerted on the Earth by the Sun is F_0 . The gravitational force exerted on the Sun by the Earth is
- equal to F_0 and in the same direction.
 - equal to F_0 and in the opposite direction.
 - much smaller than F_0 and in the same direction.
 - much smaller than F_0 and in the opposite direction.

2025 Q12

*12.



Two identical objects located at point X and point Y are at distances r and $2r$ from the Earth's centre. The weight of the object at point X is W . What is the weight of the object at point Y ?

- $0.25W$
- $0.5W$
- $0.75W$
- W

2013 Q15

- *15. It is known that the mass of Mars is about $\frac{1}{10}$ of that of the Earth while its radius is about $\frac{1}{2}$ of the Earth's radius. In terms of the gravitational acceleration g on the Earth's surface, the approximate gravitational acceleration on the surface of Mars is
- $0.2 g$.
 - $0.4 g$.
 - $2.5 g$.
 - $4 g$.

2018 Q13

- *13. A satellite of mass m moves around a planet of mass M in a circular orbit of radius r . What does the angular velocity of the satellite depend on?
- (1) r
 - (2) m
 - (3) M
- (1) only
 - (2) only
 - (1) and (3) only
 - (2) and (3) only

2020 Q10

- *10. The diameter of Neptune is about 4 times that of the Earth and its mass is about 17 times that of the Earth. Estimate the acceleration due to gravity on Neptune's surface.
Given: acceleration due to gravity on Earth's surface $g = 9.81 \text{ m s}^{-2}$

- A. 2.3 m s^{-2}
- B. 9.2 m s^{-2}
- C. 10.4 m s^{-2}
- D. 41.7 m s^{-2}

2017 Q13

- *13. A small object is released from rest at a point very far away from a planet X . The object then starts moving towards X . X does not have an atmosphere. Neglect the effect of other celestial bodies.

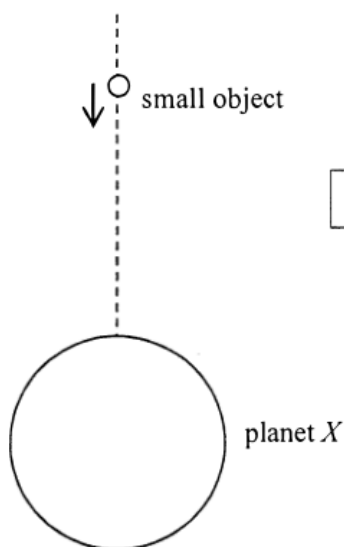
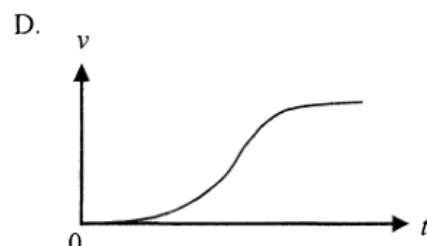
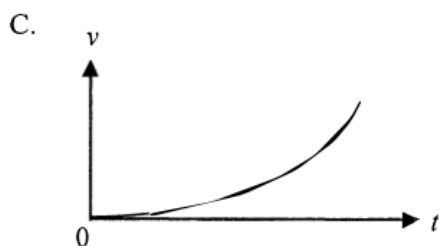
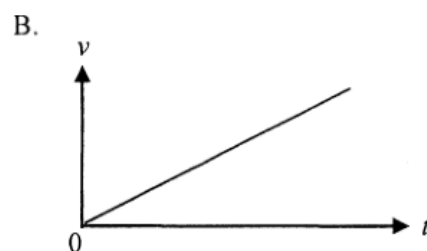
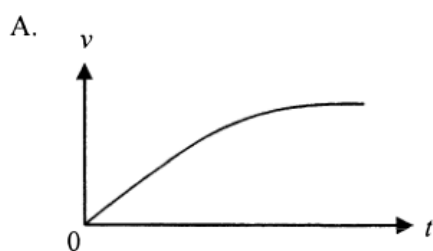


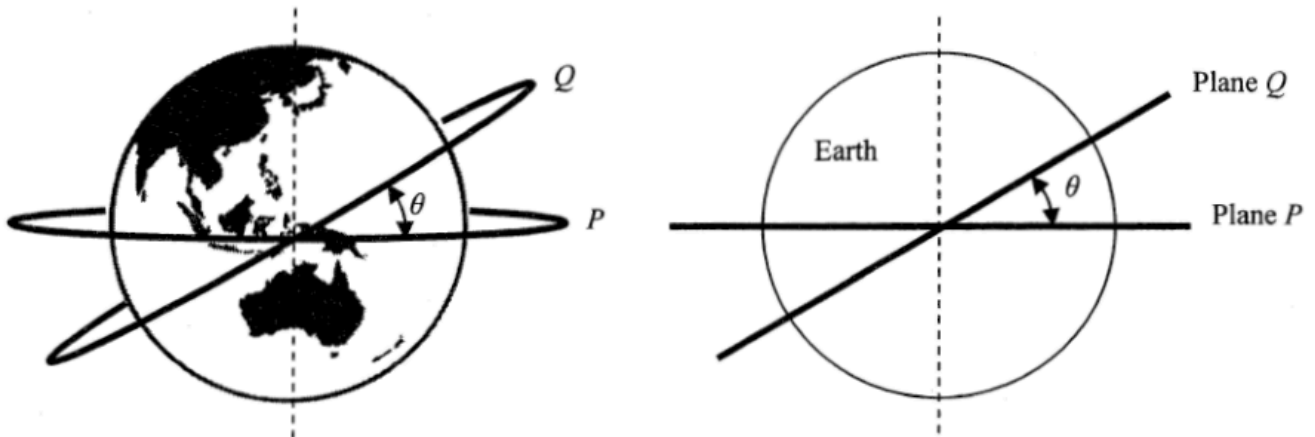
Diagram **NOT** drawn to scale

Which of the following graphs best shows the variation of the velocity v of the object with time t before it hits X ?



2012 Q14

- *14. Two satellites move in circular orbits of the same radius R around the Earth (mass M). The orbits are in two different planes P and Q as shown. Plane P coincides with the Earth's equator while plane Q is inclined to the equator at θ . Which statement is **INCORRECT**?



- A. The speed of satellite P is $\sqrt{\frac{GM}{R}}$.
- B. The centripetal force acting on satellite Q is pointing along the plane Q .
- C. The acceleration of both satellites is the same in magnitude.
- D. The period of satellite Q is longer than that of satellite P .

2014 Q12

- *12. An artificial satellite revolves in a circular orbit above the Earth's surface at a height equal to the radius of the Earth. Find the acceleration of the satellite in terms of the acceleration due to gravity g on the Earth's surface.

- A. $\frac{g}{8}$
- B. $\frac{g}{4}$

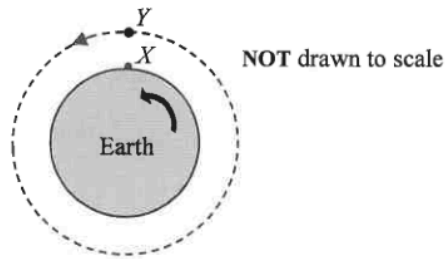
2016 Q14

- *14. A satellite orbits the Earth in a circular path of radius 7.2×10^6 m. What is the period of the satellite?
Given : mass of the Earth = 6.0×10^{24} kg

- A. 1.4 hours
- B. 1.7 hours
- C. 1 day
- D. Answer cannot be found as the mass of the satellite is not known.

2022 Q14

- *14. In the figure, X is an object resting on the Earth's equator. Y is a geostationary satellite moving in a circular orbit above the equator such that it always appears stationary to an observer on Earth.



Which descriptions about the motion of X and Y are correct ?

- (1) The motion of X and Y takes the same period.
 - (2) X is moving with a slower speed.
 - (3) X has a greater acceleration.
- A. (1) and (2) only
 - B. (1) and (3) only
 - C. (2) and (3) only
 - D. (1), (2) and (3)

2014 Q11

- *11. An astronaut inside a spacecraft moving in a circular orbit around the Earth is apparently weightless because
- A. the astronaut is too far from the Earth to feel the Earth's gravitational force.
 - B. the astronaut and the spacecraft are both moving with the same acceleration towards the Earth.
 - C. the Earth's gravitational force on the astronaut is balanced by the reaction force of the spacecraft's floor.
 - D. the Earth's gravitational force on the astronaut is balanced by the centripetal force.

2024 Q13

- *13. A satellite orbits the Earth in a circular orbit of radius r with a period of 24 hours. The period of another satellite which orbits the Earth in a circular orbit of radius $2r$ is
- A. less than 24 hours.
 - B. 24 hours.
 - C. between 24 hours and 48 hours.
 - D. more than 48 hours.

- *11. Satellites X and Y revolve around the Earth in circular orbits, in the same plane and in the same direction. The radii of their orbits are r and $4r$ respectively. The figure below shows an instant that X , Y and the Earth are on a straight line.

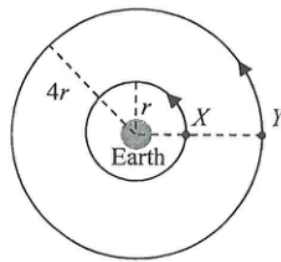
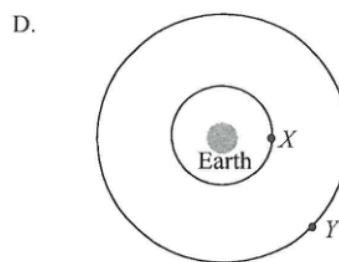
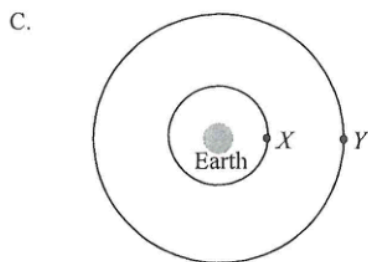
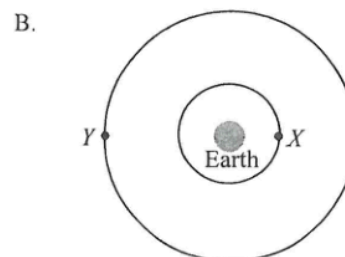
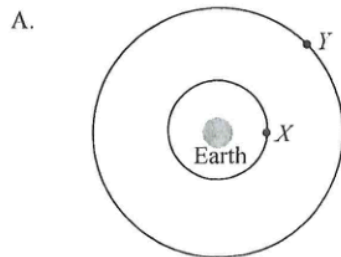


Diagram NOT drawn to scale

When X completes one cycle, which of the following diagrams best represents the position of Y ?



- *12. A rocket on the Earth's surface is launched by an upward thrust F , producing an upward acceleration g , where g is the acceleration due to gravity near the Earth's surface, as shown in Figure (a). R is the radius of the Earth.

Diagram NOT drawn to scale

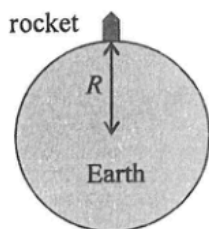


Figure (a)

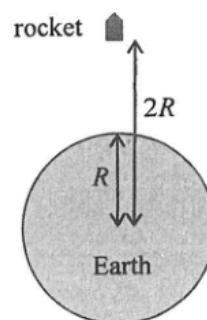


Figure (b)

Figure (b) shows an identical rocket at a distance $2R$ away from the Earth's centre. What is the upward thrust required for producing the same upward acceleration g ? Neglect air resistance.

- A. $\frac{F}{4}$
B. $\frac{F}{2}$
C. $\frac{5F}{8}$
D. $\frac{3F}{4}$